Markets — Admin Runbook

50pick · `50pick.tz` · where a market comes from, how it is resolved, how the money moves, and what the player sees. Every screenshot and every figure in this document was taken from the live platform, as the role named in its caption.

A **market** is one YES/NO question with a public source, a written criterion and a deadline. Players back a side; the two stakes form one pool; when the question is answered an officer seals the verdict and the pool pays the winning side. Nobody sets odds — the price you see is the crowd's own money, and the payout is arithmetic on the pool.

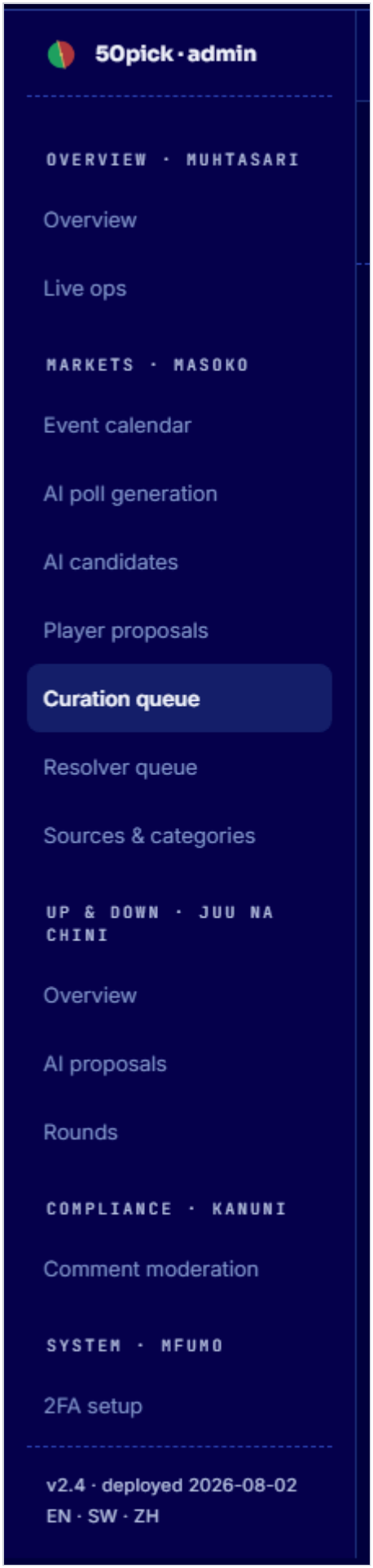
> **This is the companion to the Up & Down runbook, not a replacement.** Up & Down is the fast game: a chain emits price rounds automatically and settles itself against a feed. *Markets* are the long-form game: a human writes the question and a human seals the answer. They share the same wallet, the same ledger and the same settlement code — and they are deliberately separate portfolios for the player.

Who can do what

50pick separates **seeing** a page from **using** a control on it. Both are enforced on the server, so a screen that hides a button is not the security boundary — it is the courtesy. The table is the live mapping, read from `roles.ts` and `control-gates.ts`.

Action	Needs	Where
Create / edit a market	Trading	Curation queue → New market
Generate an AI poll · review · publish	Trading	AI poll generation
Approve or decline a player proposal	**Growth**	Player proposals
Edit the proposal prize economics	**Accounting**	Player proposals
Approve a source domain	Trading	Sources & categories
Resolve YES / NO / VOID	Trading	Resolver queue
“Re-check this market now” (one paid AI call)	**Compliance**	Resolver queue
Turn two-admin authorization on or off	**Compliance**	Resolver queue header
Emergency-void a LIVE market	**Compliance**	Curation queue
Settle a resolved market by hand	Accounting	Settlement
Rule on an objection	Compliance	Objections

> **Four of those are deliberately tighter than the page that hosts them.** Resolving is trading work, but *relaxing the two-admin rule* and *pulling a live market* move money or change a control, so they are compliance. Approving a proposal pays the proposer a bonus, so it is growth. If a control is visible but locked, that is the system telling you the truth: you can see this page, you may not fire this lever.

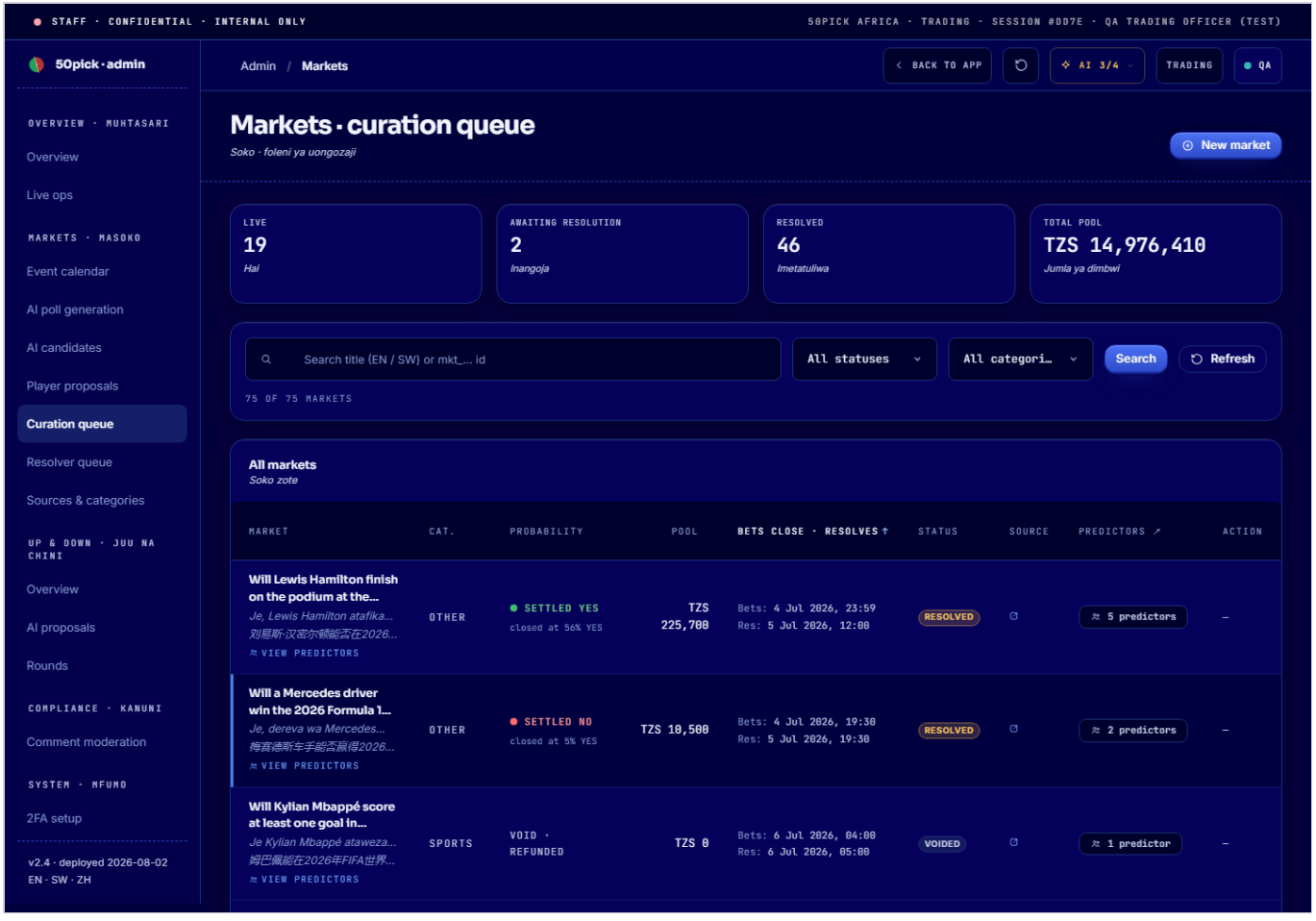


The sidebar as the **trading officer**. Everything in Parts 1–3 lives under **Markets · Masoko**. Note what is absent: no Settlement, no Objections. That is the role working, not a fault.

Part 1 · Where a market comes from

There are **four** doors, and they all end in the same place — a row in the curation queue. Only the first is fully manual.

Door	What it is
New market	You write the question. Four steps, below.
AI poll generation	The AI drafts a question with a source and a criterion; an officer reviews it and publishes. It never goes live unreviewed.
Player proposals	A player suggests a market. Approving one pays them a bonus, which is why approval is a *growth* control.
AI candidates	Ideas harvested from the event calendar, waiting to be promoted into drafts.



Curation queue, **trading officer**, live. The four counters are the whole book at a glance: LIVE 19 · awaiting resolution 2 · resolved 46 · total pool TZS 14,976,410 across 75 markets.

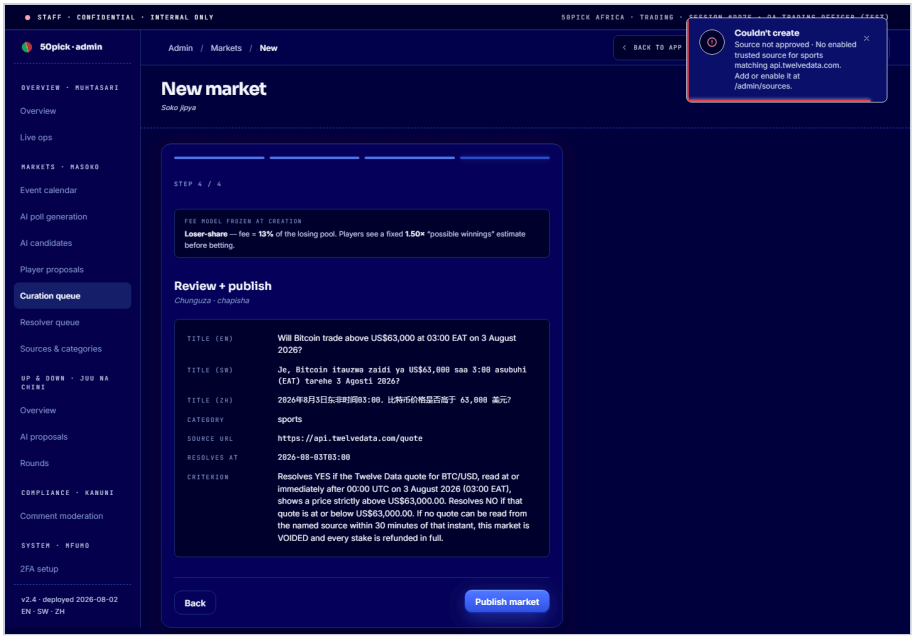
Writing one by hand — four steps

> Sidebar → **Curation queue** → “New market” (top right)

Step 1 · The question TRADING

Title in English, and optionally Swahili and Chinese. Then the **category**.

> **The category is not a label — it decides which sources you are allowed to cite.** The trusted-source allowlist is *per category*. Writing this runbook, a real market was created with the correct source URL and the default category, and the platform refused it outright (figure below). That refusal is the guard working: it is the same rule that stops a market resolving against a page nobody approved.



The real refusal, captured live: *"Source not approved · No enabled trusted source for **sports** matching api.twelvedata.com."* The domain was approved — under `crypto`, not `sports`.

Step 2 · The source and the deadline TRADING

A public URL that both officers and players will resolve against, and the resolution timestamp.

> **The timestamp is entered in East Africa time and stored in UTC.** The platform's timezone is `Africa/Dar_es_Salaam`. Type the time you mean locally; `03:00` on the form became `00:00 UTC` in the database, verified on the market created for this guide.

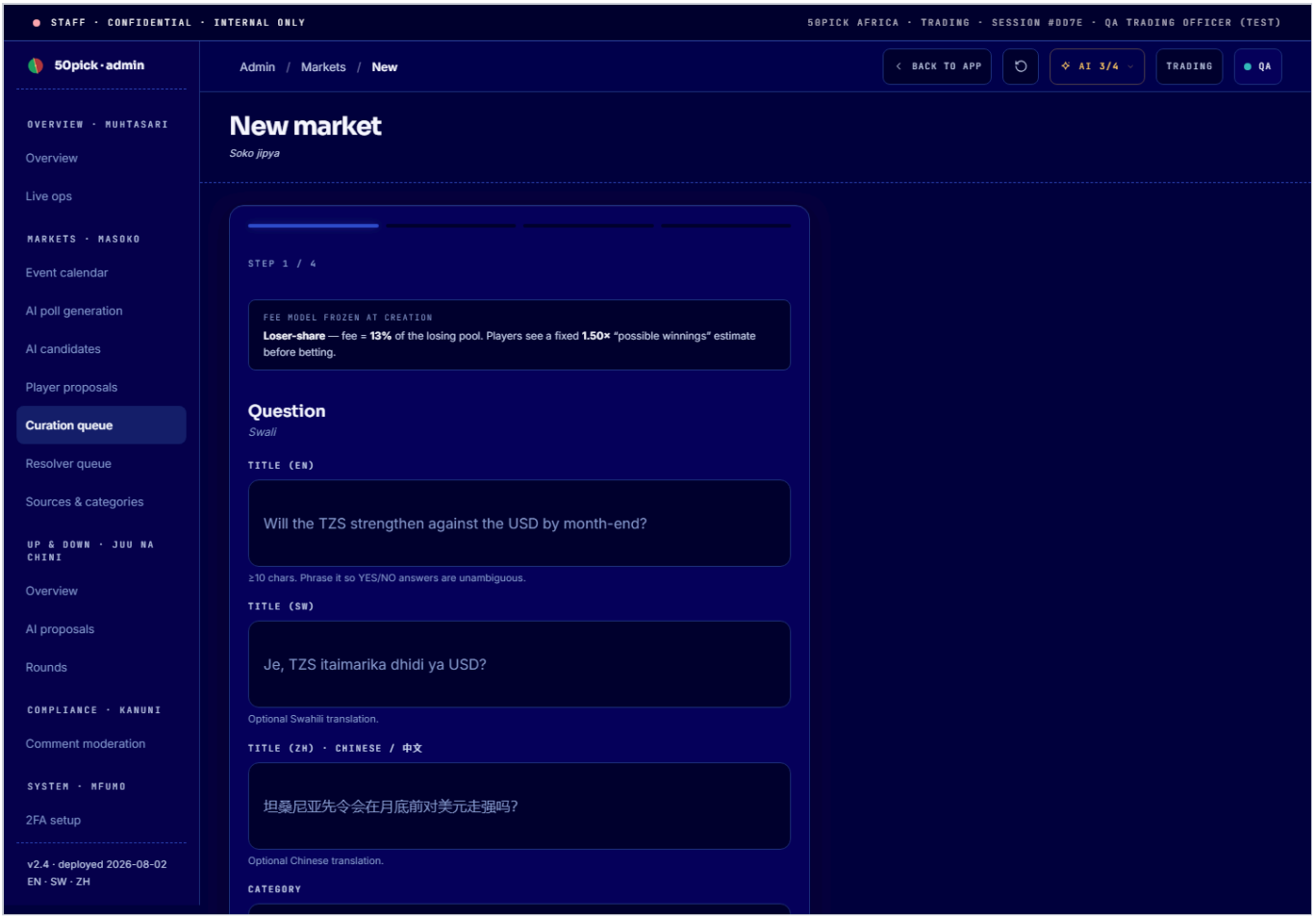
Step 3 · The criterion TRADING

At least 30 characters, and this is the text a resolver and a player are both held to. Write it so that two people reading it separately reach the same verdict.

> **Name the void condition too.** A criterion that only says when YES and NO happen leaves the third case — the source went down, the figure was never published — to whoever finds it later. The worked example at the end of this guide states its own void condition in one sentence.

Step 4 · Review, then publish TRADING

Everything on one card before it goes live. The banner above it states the fee model that will be **frozen into this market at creation** and cannot change afterwards, even if the platform's rates change tomorrow.



Step 1 of 4. The frozen fee model is stated at the top of every step, not buried in settings.

Part 2 · The money, before anyone touches it

These are the platform's live settings. The fee settings are frozen into each market when it is created; the stake bounds are not — every bet is checked against the bounds in force when it is placed, and the minimum is never below TZS 500 (since 12 October 2026; it was TZS 1,000), whatever a stored setting says.

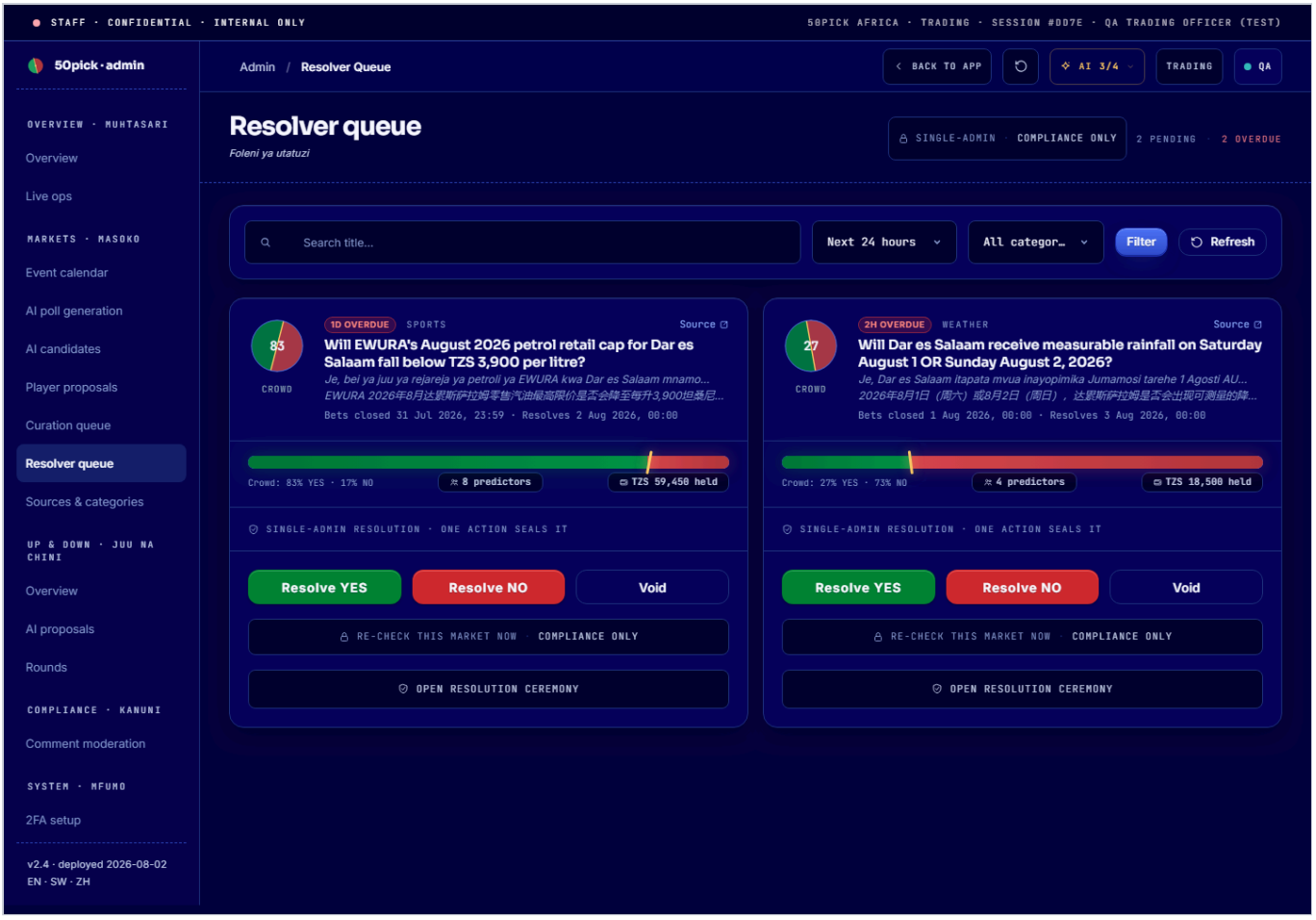
Setting	Live value	What it means
Fee model	`loser-share`	The fee comes out of the losing pool. Winners are never charged.
Commission	**13%**	Of the pool — but capped, see below.
Fee ceiling	**33.3%**	Of the *smaller* side. The fee is the LOWER of the two.
Minimum stake	TZS 500	Per bet. The platform minimum — the console refuses anything lower.
Maximum stake	TZS 1,000,000	Per bet.
Free exit	5 minutes	Cash out free within 5 minutes of placing.
Cash-out fee	0%	After the free window.
Two-admin authorization	**off**	One officer resolves in one action.

> **Why the cap exists.** On a lopsided market 13% of the whole pool can exceed the entire losing side — the platform would be taking money that only the winners put in. `fee = min(13% × pool, 33.3% × smaller side)` makes that impossible. On a one-sided market there is no losing side at all, so the fee is nothing and every stake is refunded in full.

Part 3 · Resolving

> `Sidebar → **Resolver queue**`

A market appears here when its resolution time passes. Read the card top to bottom: how late it is, how much player money it is holding, which way the crowd went, and then the three verdicts.



Resolver queue, **trading officer**, live. Two markets overdue, holding **TZS 59,450** and **TZS 18,500** of real player money. The header states the standing policy — *single-admin · one action seals it*.

Reading the card

What you see	What it means
`1D OVERDUE`	How long past its resolution time. It scales its own unit — minutes, hours, days, weeks. **The longer it waits the bigger the number gets, not smaller.**
`TZS 59,450 held`	Real player money frozen in this pool until you act. This is the number that should decide what you pick up first.
The crowd dial + bar	How the money is split. It is information, **not evidence** — resolve against the source, never against the crowd.
`Source ↗`	The URL this market must be resolved from.

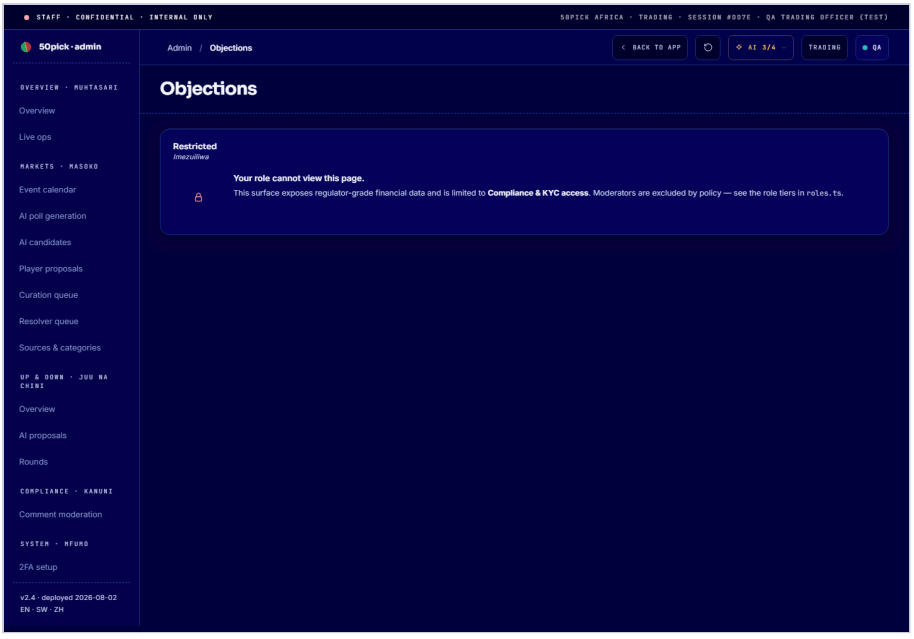
The three verdicts

Verdict	What happens to the money
Resolve YES / NO	The winning side splits the whole pool less the capped fee. Losing stakes are gone.
Void	*Every* stake is refunded in full, both sides, no fee. Use it when the question cannot be answered from its own source.

> **Resolving is not paying.** Sealing a verdict adjudicates the market; the pool stays whole and every position stays open until settlement runs. That gap is deliberate — it is the window in which an upheld objection can still change the outcome. Once settlement runs, the money is in players' wallets and cannot be clawed back.

Two controls that are not yours COMPLIANCE

“Re-check this market now” spends one paid AI call and can seal a verdict, so it stays a compliance decision even though it sits on a trading page. **Two-admin authorization** is the toggle that restores the classic two-officer ceremony; relaxing it is a compliance control by design. Both appear locked to a trading officer rather than hidden — you can see that they exist and who to ask.

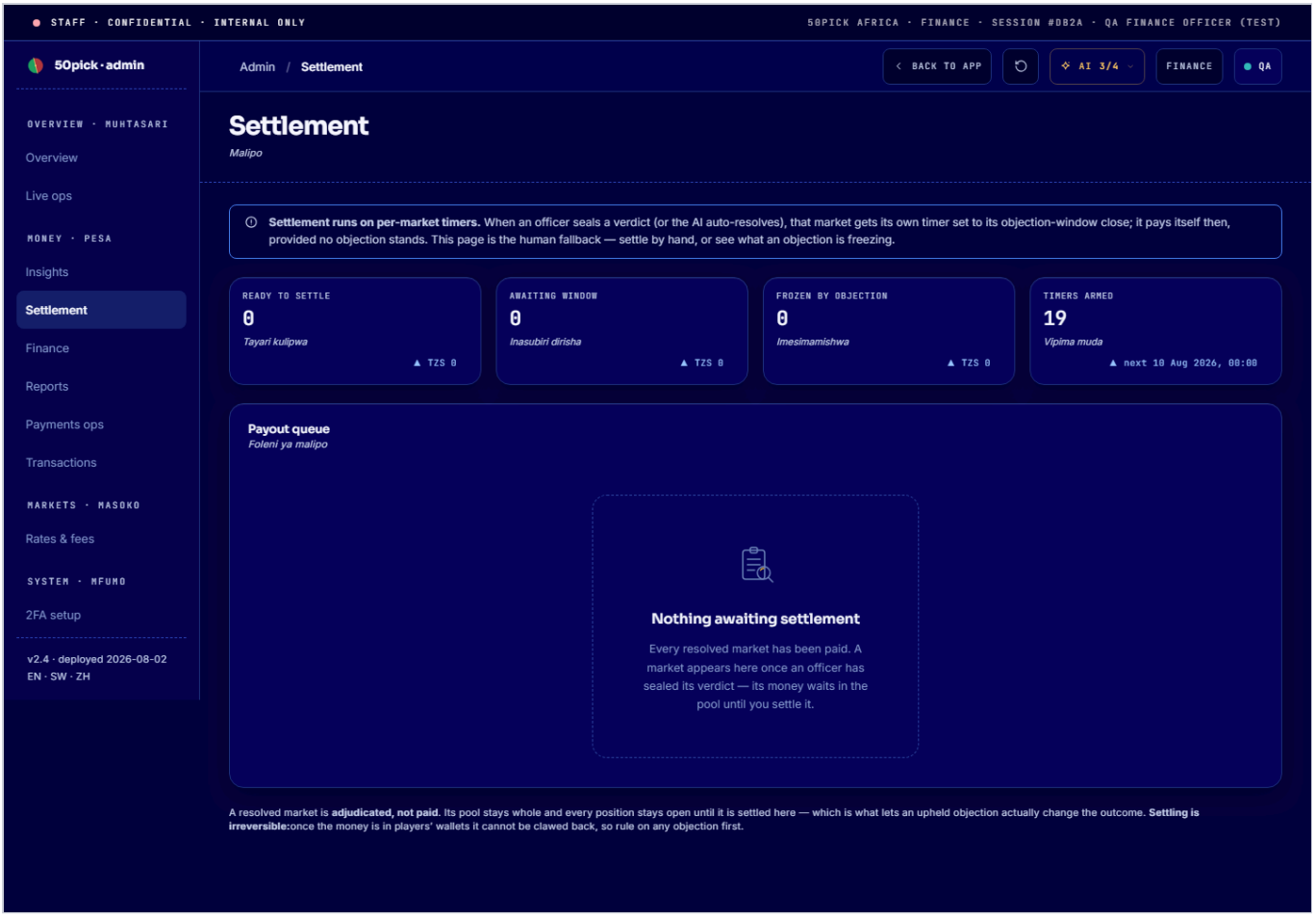


What a refusal looks like: the **trading officer** opening Objections. Trading and compliance are disjoint by default, so the page is withheld with a reason. If you see this, you are not broken — you are the wrong officer for this page.

Part 4 · Settlement — how the money actually leaves the pool

> `Sidebar → **Settlement**` ACCOUNTING

Settlement is normally **automatic**: when a verdict is sealed, that market gets its own timer set to the close of its objection window and pays itself then, provided no objection stands. This page is the human fallback — settle by hand, or see what an objection is freezing.



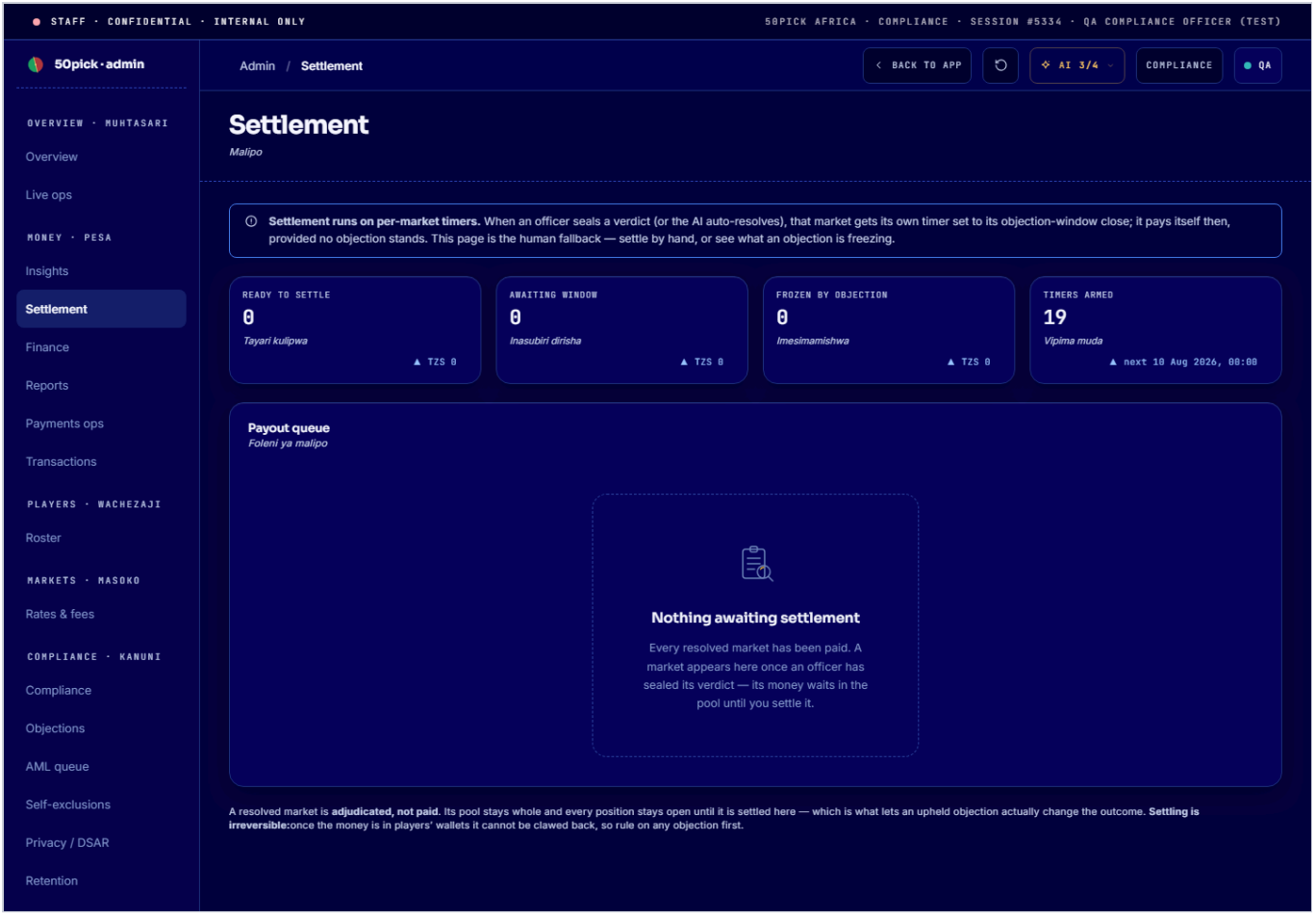
Settlement, **finance officer**, live. Nothing awaiting settlement, and **19 timers armed** — every resolved market is either already paid or has its own clock running.

Counter	What it means
Ready to settle	Verdict sealed, objection window closed, waiting to pay.
Awaiting window	Sealed, but the objection window is still open.
Frozen by objection	Someone has objected. It will not pay until that is ruled on.
Timers armed	Markets that will settle themselves, and when the next one fires.

> **Settling is irreversible.** Rule on every objection first. Once the money is in players' wallets it cannot be recovered.

Who can see this page, and who can run it

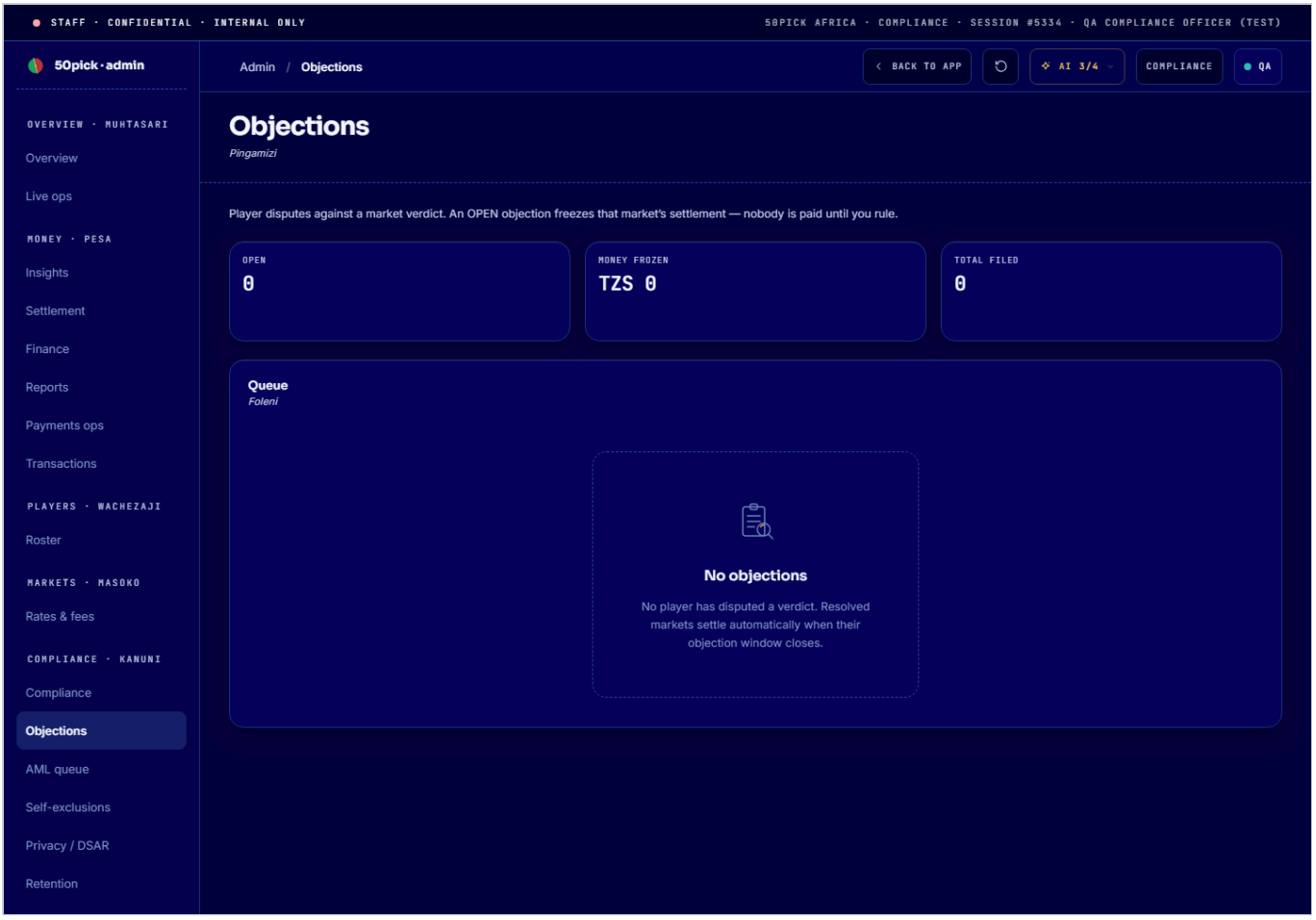
Compliance officers can *view* settlement — they hold accounting view — but running a settlement needs accounting *act*, which only finance and the owner hold. Seeing the page is not being able to fire it.



The same page as the **compliance officer**: fully visible, because compliance holds accounting *view*.

Part 5 · When something is wrong

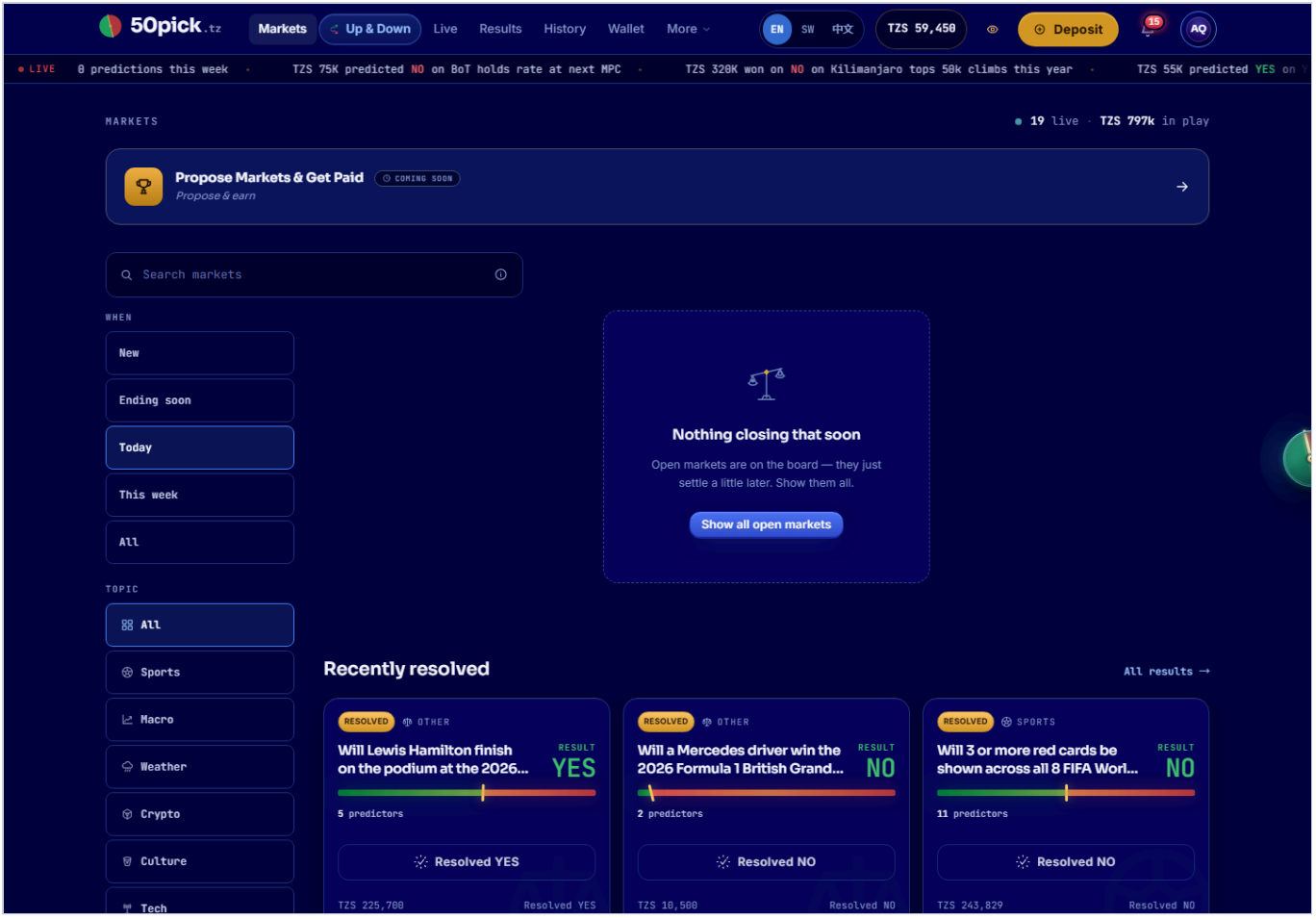
Situation	What to do
The source never published the figure	**Void.** Everyone gets their stake back. This is the honest answer, not a failure.
A LIVE market is wrong or unsafe	**Emergency void** from the curation queue `COMPLIANCE`. It pulls the market and refunds every open stake.
A player disputes a verdict	It appears in **Objections** `COMPLIANCE` and freezes settlement until ruled on.
A market is overdue and holding money	Work the resolver queue by the `TZS … held` pill, biggest first. Overdue money is the only truly urgent thing in this console.
Everything looks fine but nothing resolves	Check the **AI sentinel** — it auto-resolves settled markets on a schedule and can be paused. A paused sentinel means every market waits for a human.



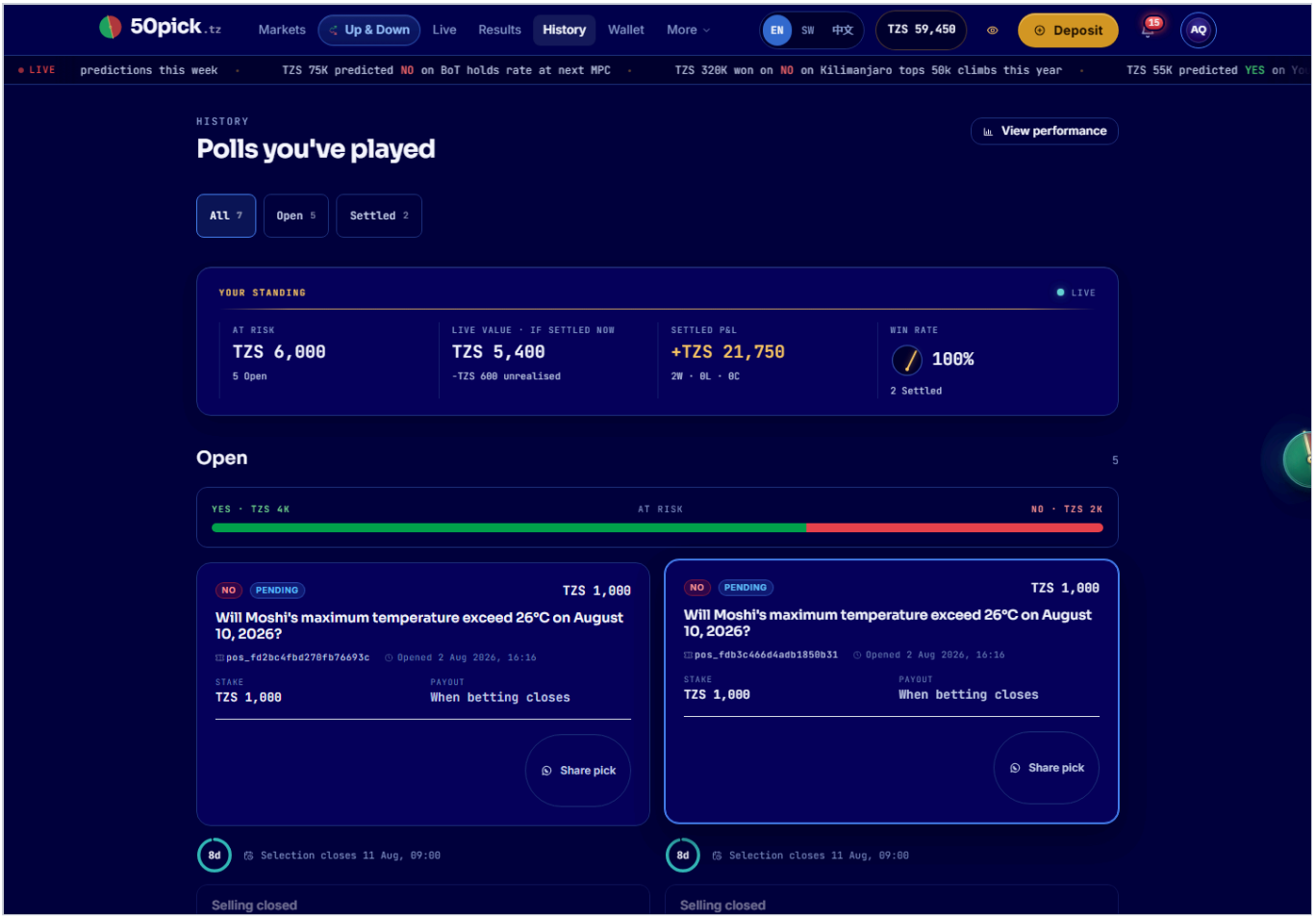
Objections, **compliance officer**, live.

Part 6 · What the player sees

Everything above produces exactly three things for the player: a market they can back, a position they can watch, and a message when it is over.

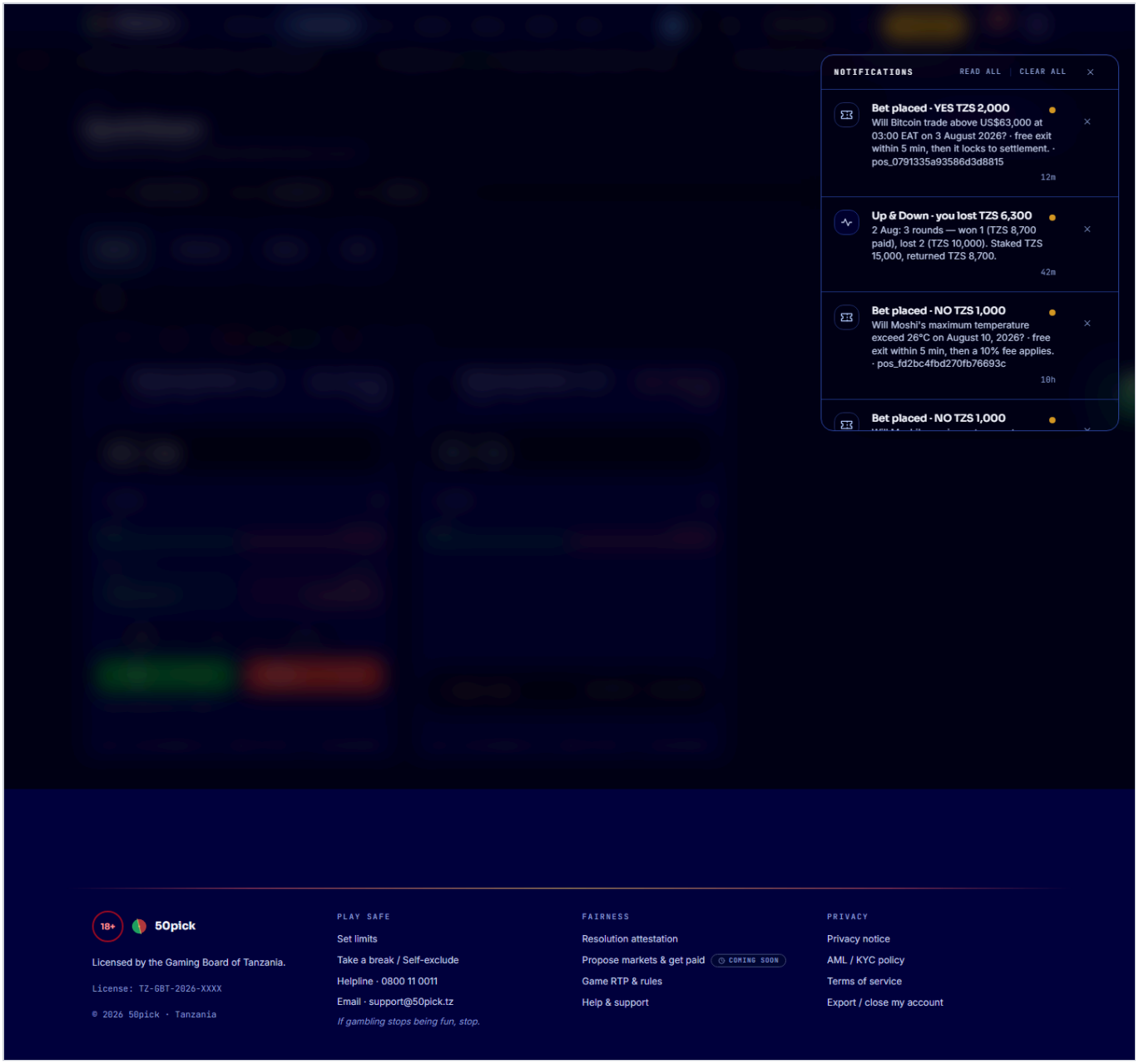


The board.

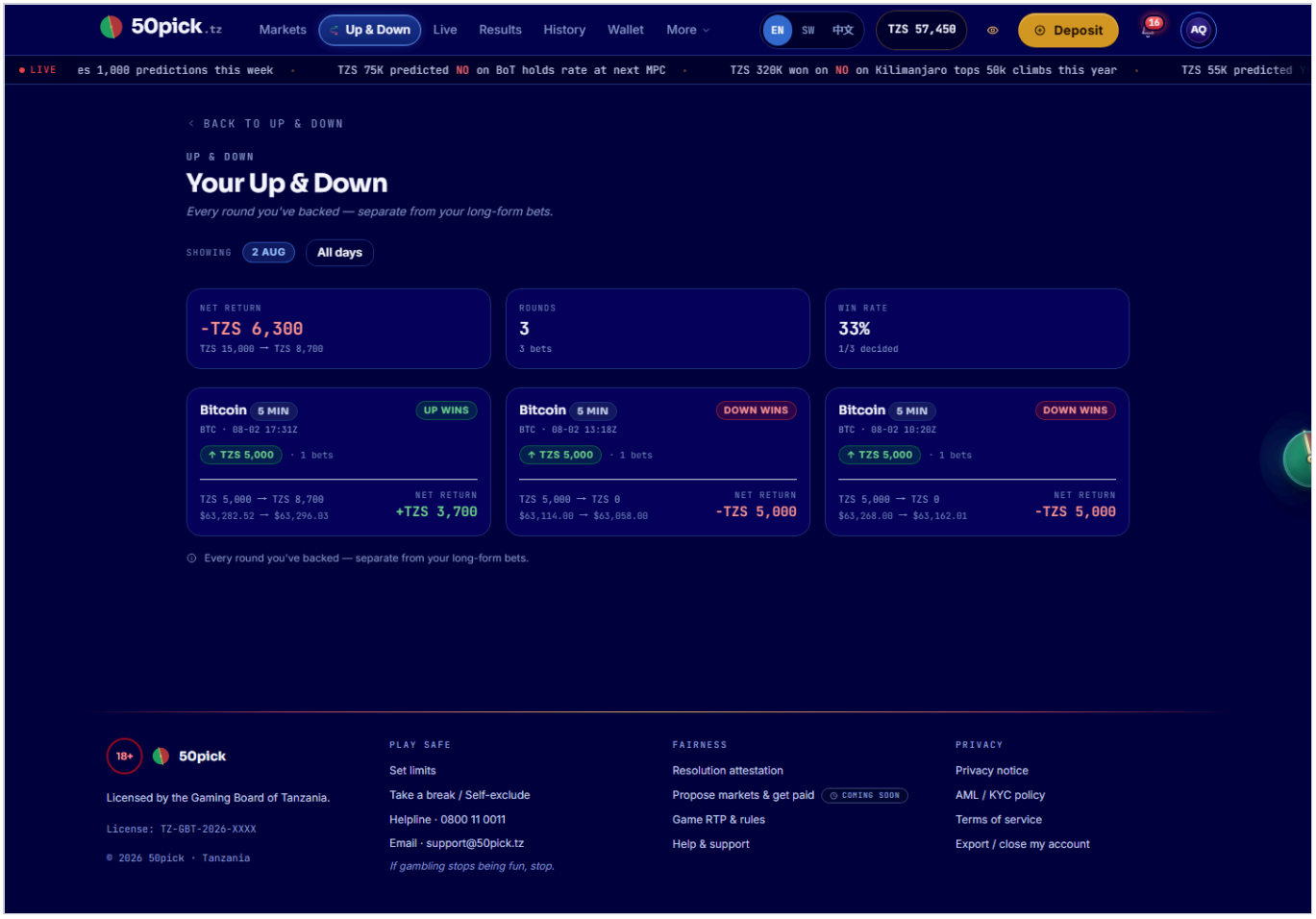


Their positions.

> **Long-form markets message the player at every step** — bet placed, betting closed with the exact payout if they are right, and the win or loss when it settles. **Up & Down does not, and that is deliberate:** a player running twenty 5-minute rounds an hour would get forty emails. Those rounds are collected into **one daily digest** instead — one message a day stating the wins, the losses and the refunds separately, with their own figures. If a player asks why they got nothing after an Up & Down round, that is the answer, and the digest arrives the next morning.



The Up & Down daily digest in a real player's bell, live: *"Up & Down · you lost TZS 6,300 — 2 Aug: 3 rounds, won 1 (TZS 8,700 paid), lost 2 (TZS 10,000). Staked TZS 15,000, returned TZS 8,700."* The loss is stated with its own count and its own figure, never folded into a net.



...and the page it links to, filtered to that one day. The digest and the history agree to the shilling — that is the point of sending the day in the link.

Part 7 · A market, start to finish — the worked example

Every figure below is from one real market created on production while writing this runbook.

```
market      mkt_54f75a1959cdee5f1ed8
question    Will Bitcoin trade above US$63,000 at 03:00 EAT on 3 August 2026?
category    crypto          source   api.twelvedata.com/quote
created     2026-08-02 23:27:48 UTC        resolves  2026-08-03 00:00:00 UTC
bets        alpha  YES  TZS 2,000          echo  NO  TZS 2,000
pool        TZS 4,000
```

Creating it — and being refused

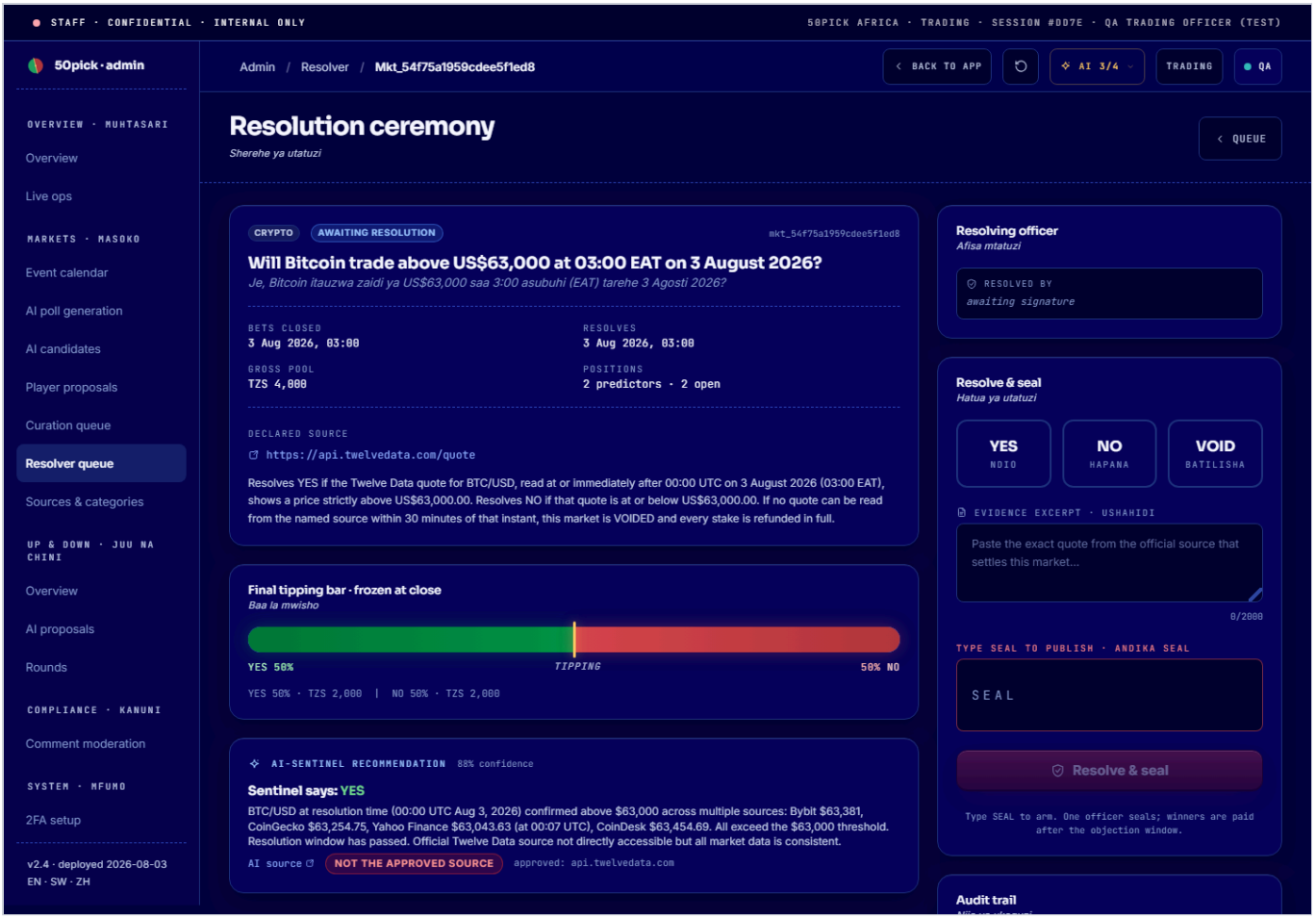
The first attempt was rejected outright, and correctly: the source domain was approved under `crypto` while the form still carried the default category `sports`. That is the figure in Part 1. Fixing the category published it in one click.

Resolving it

At the instant the criterion names — **00:00:00 UTC on 3 August 2026** — the platform's own reader was pointed at the market's own declared source:

```
BTC/USD   63,570.00     provider-quoted  2026-08-03T00:00:00.000Z
                        skew 19s (limit 90s)   →  strictly above 63,000  →  YES
```

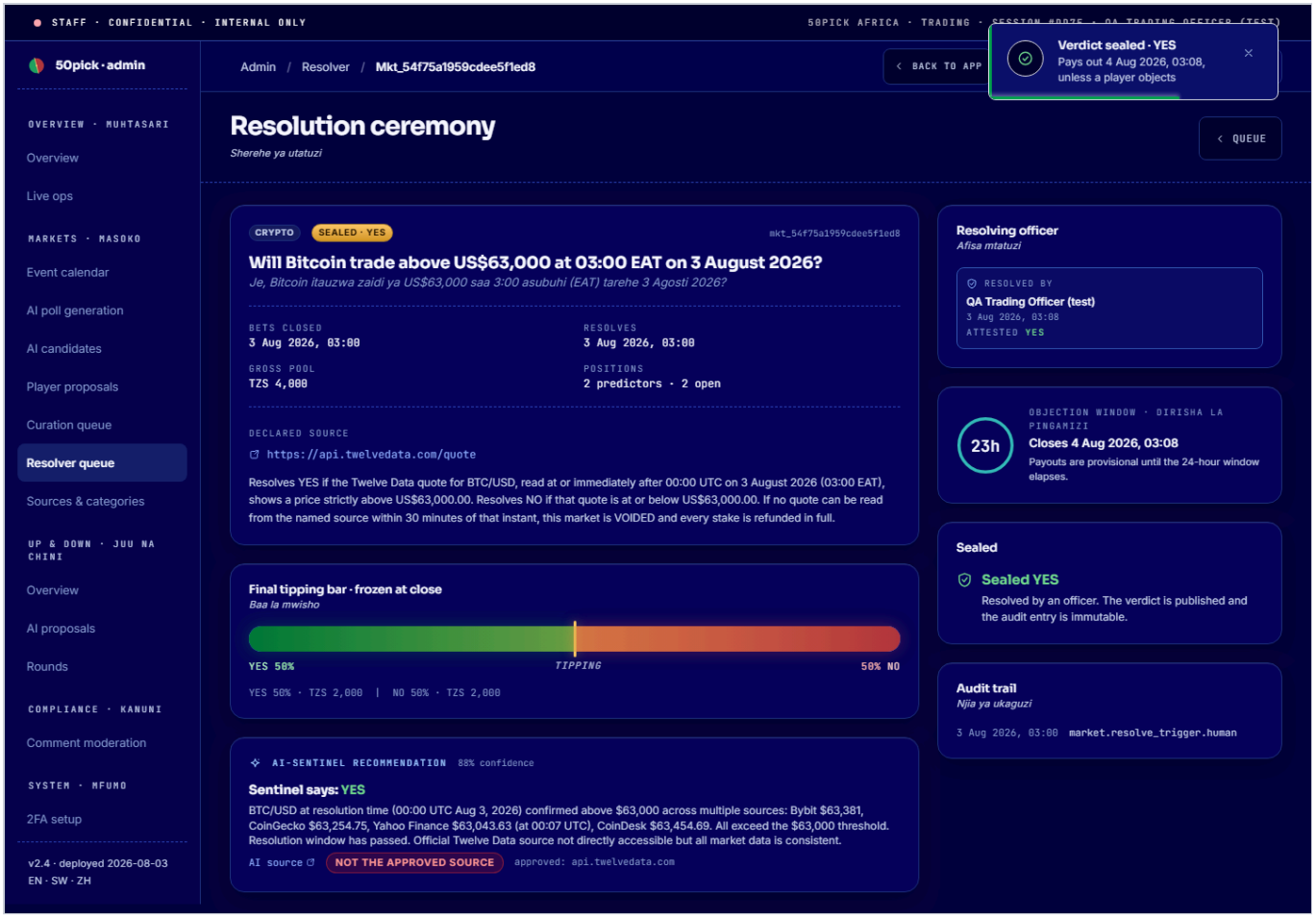
The ceremony page also carried an **independent** opinion: the AI sentinel returned **YES at 88% confidence**, citing Bybit $63,381, CoinGecko $63,254.75, Yahoo $63,043.63 and CoinDesk $63,454.69 — and the platform labelled that recommendation **“NOT THE APPROVED SOURCE”** in red, because none of those four is the domain this market declared. The two agreed, and the verdict was recorded against the approved one.



The resolution ceremony, **trading officer**, live. Pick the outcome, paste the evidence, type `SEAL`, seal. The AI's recommendation is offered and flagged, never applied.

Sealing is not paying, and the worked example proves it. Immediately after sealing, the database read: market `RESOLVED`, outcome `YES`, `settledAt` **still null**, and **both positions still** `OPEN` with both wallets unchanged. The page said the same thing — *objection window 23h, closes 4 Aug 2026 03:08, payouts are provisional until the 24-hour window elapses*. Do not read "verdict sealed" as "the players were paid"; check the wallet, not the toast.

Dated note, 2026-09-05 — the window is now 1 hour, not 24. The quotation above is a verbatim reading of the officer's screen on the day this walkthrough was captured, and it matches the photograph beside it, so its numbers are *left exactly as they were*. What has changed since is the setting: management shortened the objection window from 24 hours to 1, and every surface now reads it from configuration rather than stating it. The mechanic the worked example demonstrates — **sealing records a verdict and pays nobody** — is unchanged and is the reason to read this section. See `docs/COMPLIANCE-DECISIONS.md` (2026-09-05).



Sealed. Resolving officer named and attested, the objection window counting down, and the audit entry `market.resolve_trigger.human`.

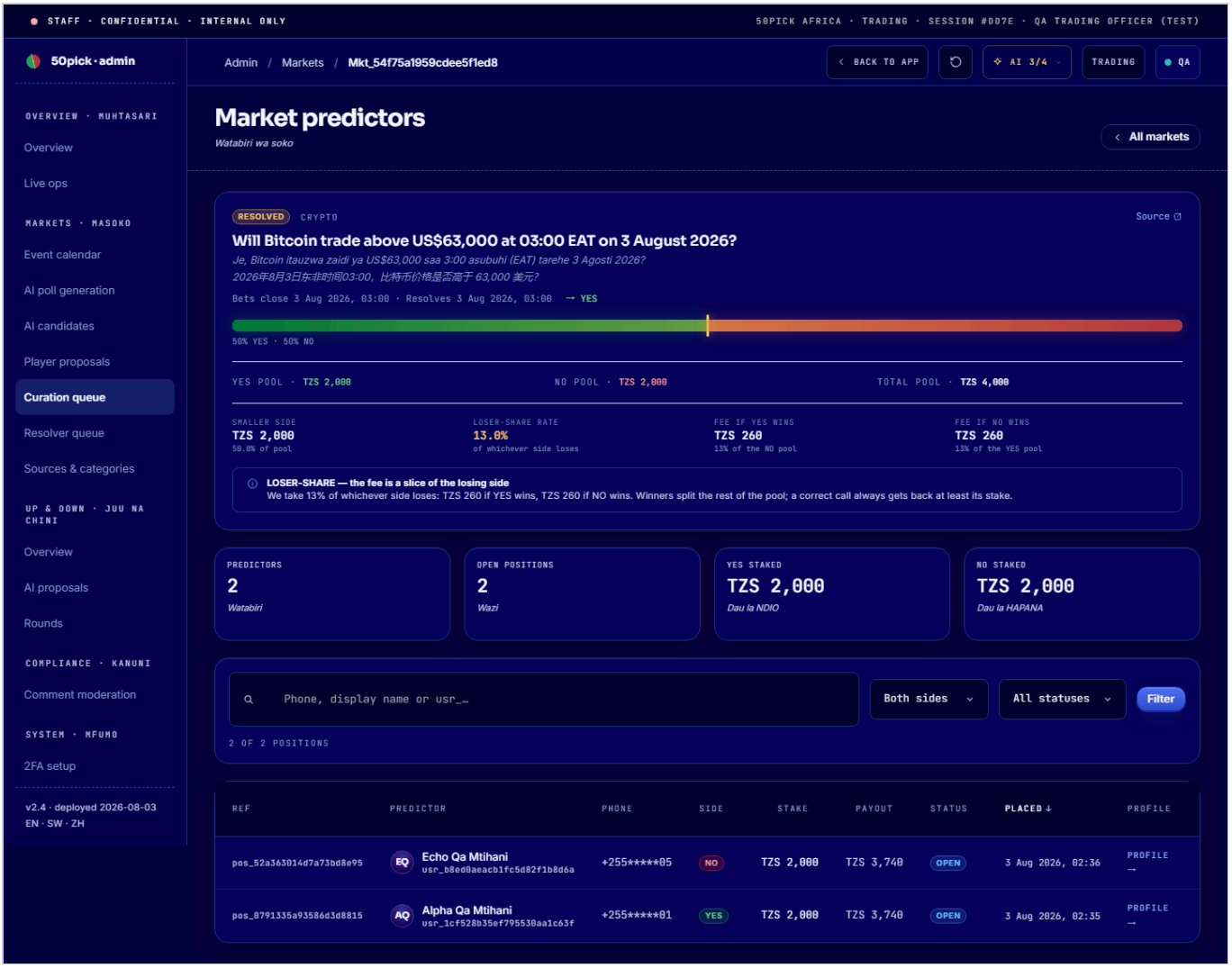
```
immediately after sealing, read from the live database:
  market     RESOLVED · YES · settledAt = null
  alpha  YES 2,000 → OPEN, payout null, wallet 57,450 (unchanged)
  echo   NO  2,000 → OPEN, payout null, wallet 25,400 (unchanged)
  objection window closes 4 Aug 2026 03:08 EAT — payout is armed for then
```

When that window closes with nothing standing, the market settles itself: the YES side takes the TZS 4,000 pool less the fee, and the NO stake is gone. This market is frozen at the **loser-share** fee model, so the fee is a slice of *the losing side only* — `(3% platform + 10% operator) × the NO pool` = `13% × 2,000` = **TZS 260**. That leaves a net pool of TZS 3,740, and alpha — the only YES predictor — receives all of it: **TZS 3,740**, a profit of TZS 1,740 on a TZS 2,000 stake.

⛔ **Never assume which fee model a market settles at — read it off that market's own page.** There are two, they produce different money on the same pools, and *both are live right now*. Counted on production on 3 August 2026, of the **19** long-form polls currently open, **7** settle at `loser-share` and **12** at `capped-commission` — so the model this worked example uses is the *minority* case, and guessing gets the majority of the board wrong.

Model	The fee	On this 2,000 v 2,000 pool	Alpha receives
`loser-share` frozen 23 Jul 2026 onward	`(3% + 10%) × the LOSING pool` depends on *who won*	13% × 2,000 = **TZS 260**	**TZS 3,740**
`capped-commission` the older model, still settling	`min(13% × the whole pool, 33.3% × the smaller side)` outcome-neutral	min(520, 666) = **TZS 520**	**TZS 3,480**

The two maths *never* mix: each market settles at the model frozen into its own `feeSnapshot` when it was created, whatever admin config says today. An earlier draft of this page applied the `capped-commission` formula to this `loser-share` market and understated alpha's payout by TZS 260. The market page shown next names the model outright — that page is the authority, not this one. `npm run test:settlement-expectation` now holds this worked example to what the settlement code actually computes, so the two can no longer drift apart.



Where the money rule is stated, as the **trading officer**: the market's own page names the model (*"LOSER-SHARE — the fee is a slice of the losing side"*), gives the rate, and prices *both* outcomes — `FEE IF YES WINS TZS 260` · `FEE IF NO WINS TZS 260` — because under this model the fee depends on who lost. The predictor grid below it carries each position's payout. ⚠️ While a market is RESOLVED but not yet settled, that column shows each side's *"if my side wins"* figure, so the losing row still reads TZS 3,740; the outcome in the header (`→ YES`) is what decides. Settlement replaces it with the amount actually paid.

Part 8 · The checklist

1. **Before creating:** is the source domain approved *under this market's category*? Is the criterion one two people would read the same way? Does it say what happens if the source is silent?
2. **Every session:** open the resolver queue and sort your attention by `TZS … held`, not by how old the card looks.
3. **Before resolving:** open the source link. Resolve from it, never from the crowd bar.
4. **Before settling:** is anything frozen by an objection? Settling is irreversible.
5. **If nothing is resolving at all:** check the sentinel is not paused before suspecting the markets.

50pick · Markets admin runbook. Generated from live production. Companion volume: *Up & Down — Operator & Player Runbook*. Rebuild with `npm run runbook:markets`; re-shoot the figures with `SHOT_DIR=docs/runbooks/markets-assets node scripts/live-markets-guide-shots.mjs`.